Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

Signet 01 is a silver signet ring. The square spiral cut into its face makes the entire object an antenna. Touched to a phone, the ring seals a written message with a mark that anyone can verify and no one can forge.

The signet

For five thousand years, a signet proved that a letter came from its sender. Now that any text can be generated in a person's name, Signet 01 restores the purpose of the signet.

How it works

1. **Write.** Open the Signet app on your iPhone and write the words you want to stand behind.
2. **Touch.** Hold the ring to your phone. The phone powers the chip, and the ring signs.
3. **Share.** The words are sealed as a permanent public record, with a link you can send to anyone.

The seal

Every seal has its own page. It shows the words, the number of the ring and the date, and confirms that the ring signed them. It opens in any browser. The reader needs no app and no account.

A seal proves that this ring signed these exact words, and when. If one character changes, the seal no longer matches. The key that signs is made inside the ring and never leaves it.

The object

Cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand. The twelve-turn square spiral is the only break in the silver. The chip sits beneath it, behind a laser-welded closure. There is no battery. The phone powers the ring each time it signs.

The silver is made to be inherited. If required, the studio can renew the electronics and refinish the silver.

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Founding Edition

Edition	Ten numbered rings, and two artist's proofs
Material	925 sterling silver, hallmarked
Price	US$10,000
Delivered with	The Signet app for iPhone

Specification

Reference	S01.AG
Antenna	12-turn square spiral, 13.56 MHz (NFC)
Chip	Arx HaLo secure element, passive, no battery
Key	Made on the chip. It cannot be exported
Record	Seals are recorded on LUKSO, a public ledger

The designer

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer based in Adelaide. He developed his practice in Melbourne, Milan, London and Amsterdam, and his work has been shown at the Triennale di Milano and the Tokyo National Museum.

He conceived Signet 01 and has directed every part of it: the form, the antenna, the electronics, the casting and the record.

Signet 01 follows Near Field Circuit (2025), ten brass NFC objects, each with its own digital record on LUKSO. All ten are held by collectors.

Made with

Prototype machining	Australian National Fabrication Facility
Casting	Morris & Watson
Bench work	Shannon Cornish
Mechanical engineering	Varghese Liju
Electronic engineering	Aaron Mohtar
RF and antenna	Dr Shengjian Chen, Flinders University
Ledger and application	Aureliano Alarcón Smith
Photography	Isamu Sawa

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Enquiries

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